Worthing Brighton Bus

Every bus on this coast: live, measured and open.

Four bus companies, the trains and the coaches, on one map, one departure board and one ticket checker, built entirely from the government's open bus data. It also keeps what the buses actually did, so anyone can see how each route really runs.

Try it live:
worthingbrightonbus.co.uk

Step 1 of 10 · Live

Every bus on one map

Every operator's buses, live, with the trains and coaches that share the coast.

Bus	Brighton & Hove · Metrobus · Stagecoach South · Compass Travel
Coach	FlixBus · National Express
Rail	Southern · Thameslink · Gatwick Express · GWR

- Bus positions from the Bus Open Data Service, refreshed every 20 seconds, for every operator in the area.
- Each bus drawn in its own livery, from the vehicle list kept by bustimes.org.
- Trains from Realtime Trains, FlixBus and National Express coaches, and rail replacement buses, on the same map.
- Tap a bus for the stops still ahead of it, when it is expected at each, the journey it runs next, and its route's registration history.

Sources: Bus Open Data Service: "free open data, and does not require a licence"; bustimes.org: the vehicle list behind each bus's livery.

Step 2 of 10 · Live

One departure board for every operator

Any stop's departures from every operator, in time order, with live, estimated and timetabled times marked apart.

- Live times from the operator's own prediction where there is one, else our estimate from where the bus is, else the timetable, and always labelled.
- Our estimates lean early: a late bus is assumed to stay most of that late, so you are more likely to wait than to miss it.
- A live time before a bus sets off, from the journey that bus is finishing now.
- Diversions and closed stops from the operators' own notices, with the nearest stop still served.
- When buses run here each day, the last bus home, and the stop's shelter, seating and step-free access.

Step 3 of 10 · Published timetable, week of 2 November 2026

Every route, day and night

The whole network drawn from the published timetables, or any one route with its stops, notices, tickets and its own performance report.

- Every route on one map, coloured by operator, with a Night buses view of what runs after dark.
- Choose an operator and a route for its stops each way, when it runs today, the notices in force and the tickets valid on it.
- Each route we track links to its route report: punctuality, waiting and where time is lost, week by week.
- Tap any stop for every service calling there and how often.

Step 4 of 10 · From the operators' published fares

The cheapest ticket, whatever the operator

Each operator's ticket zones on one map, and a checker that finds the cheapest way to cover a whole journey, across companies.

- Every operator's day-ticket zones drawn on the map.
- The cheapest combination for a journey, including tickets valid on more than one operator, weekly tickets and capped single fares.
- Single fares by route, from the operators' published fare tables.
- Where a change in ticketing would make a journey cheaper, the checker says by how much.

Sources: Bus Open Data Service: "free open data, and does not require a licence".

Step 5 of 10 · Recorded: 35 days, 27 September to 1 November

What the buses actually did

The live feed, kept every minute and matched to the timetable: real journey times, where buses lose time, and a printable report for every route we track.

- Each minute the live feed is saved, and each bus is matched to the timetabled journey it is running.
- Journey times between any two stops, by day and time of day, with the slow end shown as well as the usual.
- Waiting, bunching and punctuality at the boarding stop, once enough complete days are recorded.
- A delay map of where buses lose time; a stretch is coloured only once it has enough journeys behind it.
- Gaps in the record are listed, not hidden: 18 October.

Step 6 of 10 · Recorded and replayed

Real-time accuracy and data quality

Every figure says what it was divided by, how it was made, and what would make it wrong.

- As the board actually showed them, minute by minute, on ordinary days 79% of live times were within RTIG's window, and 86% of departures had a live time 15 minutes before they were due. We publish how often we are wrong, nightly, on the live data health page.
- Fewer than 10 journeys over 5 days shows "too few", never a number.
- 97% of 134,422 tracked journeys are matched to their journey by the operator's own feed.
- Stop times are being checked by hand at the roadside; the result will be published here.
- A bus we did not see is "missing", never "cancelled": its tracker may simply have been off.

Sources: Live estimates judged by RTIG's windows: 28 recorded days replayed (25 October 2026); What the board showed, rebuilt minute by minute (25 October 2026).

Step 7 of 10 · Live notices

One portal to the full network

What a passenger would otherwise piece together from each operator's app, a rail app and the councils' pages, in one place, with nothing to install.

Live	every bus, coach and train · rail replacement
Stops	one board for every operator · the last bus home
Notices	every operator's diversions and closures
Fares	the cheapest ticket across companies

- Every operator's buses live on one map, with the coaches, the trains and rail replacement.
- One departure board for any stop, whoever runs the bus, with live, estimated and timetabled times marked apart.
- Every operator's diversions and closures from the Bus Open Data Service, one card for each set of works, with the nearest stop still served.
- Every route's stops, hours and tickets, and the cheapest ticket for a journey across companies.
- How each route really runs, from the recorded days, and the site's own analysis under News and Analysis, each piece with its sources.

Sources: Bus Open Data Service: "free open data, and does not require a licence".

Where the network falls short

The same data shows where the network serves people less well. On this coast, services west of the council boundary at Portslade are weaker on every measure.

- Weekday departures per stop: 64.9 west of the line against 99.7 east, in a band 4 km either side (65%).
- Routes on a weekday: 20 against 39. On Saturday 11 against 25; on Sunday 9 against 22.
- Departures after 11pm on a weekday: 581 west of the line against 1,376 east.
- Lancing and South Portslade, about five miles apart on the same coast road: 32.8 against 121.7 weekday departures per stop.
- Joint working pays: up to 43% more passengers on the two routes the councils improved together. The coast west of Portslade wasn't one of them.
- Better buses sets out what would help, who is responsible for each change and how far it has got, and drafts a letter to your councillor.

Sources: Brighton & Hove Bus Service Improvement Plan, 2025 refresh (joint scheme with West Sussex on routes 17 and 273, PDF page 22); The generated boundary evidence.

Open, accessible and cheap to run

No login and no app to install. Built for every reader, from open data, under an open licence.

- Accessible by design: dark mode, larger text, reduced motion and colour-blind-safe colours, with every control reachable by keyboard.
- ABOD, the Department's free analytics service, is for operators and councils, by invitation. This is open to everyone, and joins the evidence to passenger tools.
- ABOD matches a bus to its journey one way and skips it when that fails. This site tries three ways, and names 97% of tracked journeys by the operator's own feed.
- ABOD's code may be reused only by KPMG firms. This site's code is MIT-licensed, its words and data are CC BY, and every day's evidence is archived in public.
- The data is free and so is the hosting: under £20 a year, the cost of the web address. A template for other regions is on the way.

Sources: Analyse Bus Open Data (RTIG); ABOD's matching method (OTP Matching); ABOD's licence; Bus Open Data Service: "free open data, and does not require a licence"; Render: the free instance type the live data runs on.

Let's build it together

The code is open and the data is public. Operators: check our figures. Councils: plan the coast as one corridor. Other regions and technology firms: help turn this into a template.

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The code on GitHub

The tour on your phone